existing carbon load. Second, it generates emissions but offsets this by capturing an equivalent amount of carbon, thereby being a net zero contributor of carbon. Third, it generates more emissions than it offsets, thereby being a net contributor of carbon.

The regulatory environmental standards can be established to make a measurement of carbon, both emissions and its capture/reduction, mandatory for every business. With the rapid evolution of digital technology, such measurement can be a continuous 24/7 process. The regulatory system can also determine a price per kg of carbon.

With the carbon price so determined and carbon emissions/capture measured continuously, businesses can be expected to determine in financial terms their net priced carbon emissions/capture. They can be mandated to pay for their net emissions to society/government and be rewarded for their net emissions capture. There is a case for instituting a carbon levy for neutralizing the cost such businesses impose on society and economy. Net emitting businesses should have complete freedom to make investments to bring their net emissions to zero or purchase emission credits from the market equal to their net emissions. They can also be given the option to deposit an equivalent carbon cost with the government concerned to discharge their carbon liability; it can use such proceeds to pay for carbon capture investments. This whole arrangement would lead to net-zero national contribution and development of a carbon market.

The present state of carbon emissions and pollutant discharges in almost all countries is above net zero. In fact, in many economies, emissions and discharges are still rising. Many of these countries justify these increasing carbon emissions as necessary to support their growth. They have a right to do so. In such countries, the governments could provide an arrangement to socialize such costs according to some standards on a tapering basis for a specified period of time. Governments can also provide financial incentives